

The Noble Discourse Called "That Terrifies All Māras"

Ārya-sarvamāra-bhayamkara-nāma · Toh 797 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བདད་ཐམས་ཅད་སྒྲུ་པར་བཞེ་པ་ཞེས་བུ།

This short work, known in English as "That Terrifies All Māras" (likely corresponding to a Sanskrit title such as Sarva-māra-pramardana or similar, with the Tibetan title 'phags pa bdud thams cad skrag par byed pa), is a dhāraṇī text centered on a protective mantra invoked in homage to the Buddha Śākyamuni. Its opening verses present the mantra itself, praising the tathāgatas' jeweled qualities, and describe its power to bring rejoicing among benevolent deities while striking terror into malevolent forces—dark māras and arrogant spirits alike. As such, it belongs to the genre of apotropaic or protective dhāraṇī literature, texts recited for spiritual safeguarding and the subjugation of harmful influences. This text is catalogued as Toh 797 in the Kangyur, situating it among the collection of canonical scriptures attributed to the Buddha's word.

It is finished.

The noble discourse called "That Terrifies All Māras."

Homage to the Blessed One, Śākyamuni.

Oṃ sarva tathāgata maṇi śata dapti jvala jvala dharmadhātu garbhe maṇi maṇi mahāmaṇi hṛdaya maṇi svāhā.

By reciting this mantra, the gods of the pure side rejoice and offer protection. All the black māras are struck with dread and swoon. The wicked and arrogant spirits are terrified, and...

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence ("terrified, and..."), reflecting the source text as given. The opening "It is finished" appears to be a colophon carried over from a preceding text rather than belonging to this dhāraṇī itself. The mantra syllables are rendered in transliterated Sanskrit as found in the Tibetan phonetic spelling; some elements (e.g., "śata dapti") are of uncertain precise Sanskrit reconstruction and are given as transliterated rather than translated, per standard treatment of mantra.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.